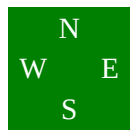


Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 10 5 3
♥ Q J 10 3
♦ 10 8 3
♣ 9 3

♠ A 8 2
♥ K 6 5
♦ K 4 2
♣ Q J 7 4



♠ 6
♥ A 8 7 2
♦ Q J 9 7
♣ 10 8 5 2

♠ K Q 9 7 4
♥ 9 4
♦ A 6 5
♣ A K 6

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
on the third ♥ which you ruff.

South's 2♦ bid was New Minor Forcing, asking if North has 3 ♠s. North's 2♠ response said "Yes, I have." South is to play 4♠. West leads the ♥Q.

Losers: ♠ = ? ♥ = 2 ♦ = 1 ♣ = 0 Total = 3?

If the ♠s split 3-2 as they should, you have no ♠ loser and your plan will merely be to pull trumps and play winners. So what you do in that case is start figuring how to deal with a 4-1 split.

But first you should deal with the ♥K situation. Do you cover the ♥Q or not?

Competent defenders do not underlead Aces at suit contracts. So if you are playing against a competent West you certainly don't cover. You play low on this trick and on the ♥J continuation, hoping East started with a doubleton ♥A. But he didn't, and he plays it

Back to the Plan. Having ruffed the ♥ you are down to just 4 trumps in your hand. You play ♠A, ♠K, ♠Q, noting that East discards on the second round. Therefore West will get a trump trick.

But don't give it to him now! Leave West with his master trump and switch to ♣s. If West doesn't ruff at all you will run 4 ♣ tricks and discard your ♦ loser. If he does decide to ruff it will be with a trick you were going to lose anyway. You win his return, ruffing a ♥ with the last trump, and continue playing ♣ and ♦ winners.

You can't help losing two ♥s and one ♠.

But you don't have to lose anything else as long as you don't lose trump control. So leave the master trump with West and just cash your minor suit winners. Let West ruff whenever he wants to because that will establish your ♠9 to control any more ♥ leads. If he decides not to ruff at all then he can have the final trick with his high trump.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 4
♥ J 9 5 2
♦ Q J 10 6 3
♣ 10 8 4

♠ 10 8
♥ K Q 8 6
♦ 8 7 2
♣ 9 7 5 3



♠ J 7 6 2
♥ 10 7 4 3
♦ 9 5
♣ Q J 6

♠ A K Q 9 5 3
♥ A
♦ A K 4
♣ A K 2

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			

6 ♠ by South

going to lose a trump in any case. Play dummy's ♥ K Q, discarding your two minor losers. Ruff a ♥ to return to your hand, pull trumps and claim.

As you can see you have a trump loser in addition to the small ♦ and ♣. By establishing the ♠ entry to dummy you can discard the ♦ and ♣.

You can see how it works if the trump suit DID split 3-2 as you would expect it to do. Even without a trump loser you will still go down 1 if you cannot take two discards on dummy's ♥s.

So you give up a trump trick and gain two ♥ tricks in return. What a deal.

South is to play 6 ♠. West leads the ♦ Q.

Losers: ♠ = 0 or 1 ♥ = 0 ♦ = 1 ♣ = 1 Total = 2 or 3

You probably do not have a trump loser because they will probably split 3-2. Still, a 4-1 split is certainly not out of the question.

But those two minor suit losers are definite **UNLESS** you can somehow get to dummy's ♥ K Q. Can you?

Yes you can get to dummy, in the trump suit. Win the opening ♦ lead. Unblock the ♥ A before touching trumps. Play a **SMALL** trump toward dummy. A defender will surely take his ♠ J here, and play another ♦. Win that trick and play another small ♠. This one will get you into dummy. And by the way, West discards a ♦ so it turns out you were

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 8 6 3

♥ Q 8 7

♦ A Q 10 5

♣ 4

♠ A Q

♥ 6 4 3

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ 6 5 3 2



♠ 7 5 4 2

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ K J 9 3

♣ 10

♠ K 9

♥ A J 9

♦ 6

♣ A K Q J 9 8 7

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

1NT

Pass

3 ♣

Pass

4 ♣

Pass

5 ♣

All Pass

5 ♣ by South